

# EA HOSPITALITY PULSE

Daily intelligence for city, bush & beach properties across East Africa

## Sunday Foresight

2026-09-20

Uganda was declared Ebola-free on 25 August. Entebbe's August traffic still fell 29.1%. That is what a risk label costs — invoiced this week at 69,623 passengers.

The region read Uganda's restrictions as a policy story. On Friday UCAA turned it into an accounting entry: 169,706 international passengers in August, 29.1% below August 2025 — a peak month, no case, a WHO all-clear on the record. Zanzibar, same month, same outbreak next door, set an all-time record: 124,481 arrivals, +18%, 92.9% occupancy. One was named in other people's documents. The other was not.

What everyone is missing. Arrivals were 88,270 against 81,436 departures — a 6,834 gap UCAA attributes to restrictions on Ugandans travelling out. The label is also keeping Uganda's outbound market at home: zero-cost demand, unsold. And France reframed Kenya on 15 September as pre-electoral. Entebbe's number is Kenya's price list.

### THE WEEK'S SIGNALS

#### 1 THE LABEL NOW HAS A PRICE: 69,623 PASSENGERS

UCAA August, reported 18 Sep: 169,706 int'l pax, -29.1% on August 2025's 239,329; H1 already -10.8%. KLM still absent post-all-clear, Uganda Airlines' Kinshasa route suspended, Dubai still restricting Uganda-origin traffic.

**So what: at +8.5%/month from a 29% hole, August 2025 is four clean months away. Budget FY2027 off that curve, not the all-clear.**

*City, Bush | | Confirmed (figures) | impact:demand*

#### 2 THE UNNAMED MARKET TOOK THE RECORD

OCGS August: 949,056 of Zanzibar's 1,021,853 bed spaces sold; Europe 58.1%, Italy top at 17,608.

**So what: naming sorted these two markets, not epidemiology. List every source market reaching you via a government that names your country. That is your risk register.**

*Beach, City, Bush | | Confirmed (figures) / Inference (read) | impact:demand*

#### 3 THE 16 SEPTEMBER ORDER NOW REACHES YOUR AMERICAN GUEST

Extended to 11 Oct and, for the first time, binding certain US citizens: 21 days outside the US after DRC, and Uganda or South Sudan arrivals routed via four designated airports. DRC: 7,475 cases, 3,605 deaths at 16 Sep (WHO, 17 Sep).

**So what: name the four-airport routing in every US pre-departure pack touching Uganda, transit included. A surprise at ticketing is a cancellation.**

*Bush, City | | Confirmed (primary) | impact:risk*

#### 4 AND KENYA ACQUIRED A LABEL ON 15 SEPTEMBER

France Diplomatie's Kenya security page, updated 15 Sep 2026, describes an active pre-electoral situation a year out from the 10 Aug 2027 vote, warning of blockages, disruption and sometimes

deadly violence. No incident moved a curve; a sentence moved.

**So what: eleven months is enough to make this a contract term, not a crisis. Election-period rebooking clause into every 2027 contract, beside the statutory-cost clause.**

*City, Beach, Bush* | | *Confirmed (primary) / Inference (read)* | *impact:risk*

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### 30/90-DAY DEMAND CALENDAR

25–27 Sep — UWA Open Park Days; foreign-visitor eligibility unsettled, confirm before quoting. 27 Sep: World Tourism Day, Mbale — compression, no branded stock. Hold rate.

1–2 Oct — Africa MICE Summit, Mombasa, not Nairobi. Coast: hold 30 Sep–2 Oct.

~11 Oct — the CDC order lapses or renews. The one date that moves Entebbe's curve.

14 Oct — fuel VAT and the EPRA cycle expire; 25 Oct, KQ halves Nairobi–Dubai to 7 weekly.

If a foreign ministry can move 29% of your peak month without naming one case, whose document are you trading under?

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